

Stronghold (TM) Frequently Asked Questions
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Stronghold booster packs, tournament packs, and theme decks go on sale in the _Magic Online_ (TM) store at 9 a.m. (PST) on Monday April 13, 2009.

The _Stronghold_ set becomes legal for play in Classic, Classic (Vanguard), Freeform, Tempest Block Constructed, Prismatic, Singleton, and Tribal Wars (Classic) formats on the day it goes on sale.

Stronghold release events begin on Friday April 17, 2009.

The _Stronghold_ expansion, originally released in 1998, is a 143-card, black-bordered set featuring 44 rares, 44 uncommons, and 55 commons. The _Stronghold_ set is nonredeemable. Online cards from the _Stronghold_ set can't be exchanged for physical _Stronghold_ cards.

This FAQ has two sections, each of which serves a different purpose.

The first section ("General Notes") explains the new mechanics and concepts in the set. The second section ("Card-Specific Notes") contains answers to the most important questions players might ask about a given card.

Items in the "Card-Specific Notes" section include full rules text for your reference. Not all cards in the set are listed.

GENERAL NOTES

Info: Rules Changes

The rules of the _Magic_ (TM) game have evolved over the years since the _Stronghold_ set was originally released. Many card wordings, including creature types, have also significantly changed. Most _Stronghold_ cards have been reworded in the Oracle card reference, which contains up-to-date text for all tournament-legal cards. Although the rules team has done its best to maintain cards' functionality, some changes are inevitable.

The _Stronghold_ set introduces no new keywords. It contains many keywords, themes, and mechanics that were introduced in the _Tempest_ (TM) set, however. For information on the following topics, please see the _Tempest_ FAQ (http://www.wizards.com/dci/downloads/Tempest_FAQ_EN.doc):

Buyback
Shadow
Slivers
Licids
Graveyard Order Matters

Theme: En-Kor Creatures

Each creature in this set with "en-Kor" in its name has an activated ability that can redirect damage that would be dealt to it.

Nomads en-Kor

{W}

Creature ? Kor Nomad Soldier

1/1

{0}: The next 1 damage that would be dealt to Nomads en-Kor this turn is dealt to target creature you control instead.

* You may activate this ability any number of times, each time targeting any creature you control, whether or not any foreseeable damage would be dealt to the en-Kor creature.

* You may target the en-Kor creature itself with this ability. However, unless something triggers when that creature becomes the target of an ability, this will have no noticeable effect.

* If the targeted creature leaves play before the redirection shield is used, the damage is not redirected. It will be dealt to the en-Kor creature as normal.

* Redirecting damage doesn't change its source. In other words, the en-Kor creature doesn't deal damage to the target of its ability -- the original source of the damage does, no matter which creature it's dealt to.

* If the damage that would be dealt to an en-Kor creature is combat damage or unpreventable damage, it will still be combat damage or unpreventable damage after it has been redirected.

* At the time damage would be dealt to an en-Kor creature, its controller chooses which redirection and/or prevention shields to apply out of all the shields that have been created that turn. It doesn't matter what order they were created in. All such shields are applied at the same time.

* Other effects that modify what happens if a source would deal damage, such as the one from Furnace of Rath, for example, will be applied only once. They won't apply both before and after the en-Kor's redirection effect, but you can choose whether they apply before or after.

* You may redirect an amount of damage to a creature that's greater than its toughness. For example, if 3 damage would be dealt to an en-Kor creature, you may activate its ability three times targeting a 1/1 creature. All 3 damage will be redirected.

* Redirection shields affect only damage that would actually be dealt to the en-Kor creature. For example, if Nomads en-Kor blocks a 4/4 creature with trample, and 1 damage was assigned to the Nomads and 3 damage was assigned to the defending player, the Nomads's ability could redirect only 1 damage. The damage assigned to the player is unaffected.

* All damage has to be dealt (or prevented) eventually. If you control two en-Kor creatures, activating their abilities multiple times could redirect the

same damage back and forth between them. At some point, however, those shields must be depleted and the damage will be dealt.

Theme: Spikes

Spike is a creature type. Each Spike in this set is a green creature that comes into play with a certain number of +1/+1 counters on it, and each one has an activated ability that lets you remove a +1/+1 counter to put a +1/+1 counter on a target creature. Some of them have additional abilities that let you remove a +1/+1 counter for another purpose.

Spike Feeder

{1}{G}{G}

Creature ? Spike

0/0

Spike Feeder comes into play with two +1/+1 counters on it.

{2}, Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spike Feeder: Put a +1/+1 counter on target creature.

Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spike Feeder: You gain 2 life.

* A Spike's second ability doesn't move a +1/+1 counter from itself to the targeted creature. Rather, one +1/+1 counter is removed from the Spike as part of the cost of its ability, then later, when the ability resolves, a different +1/+1 counter is put on the targeted creature. Even if a counter can't be put on the target at the time the ability would resolve, the +1/+1 counter will be long gone from the Spike.

* A Spike's ability works with any +1/+1 counter on that Spike, not just the ones it came into play with. (All +1/+1 counters are indistinguishable.)

* If a Spike has been dealt damage, not all of its counters can be removed to play its abilities that turn. For example, if Spike Feeder has been dealt 1 damage, playing either its second or third ability will cause it to be a 1/1 creature with 1 damage on it, so it will be destroyed as a state-based effect. The ability you played will resolve, but you won't get a chance to remove the last counter.

Abilities That Affect Attacking and Blocking

The Stronghold set has a number of cards with abilities that affect what can and can't attack or block this turn. Whether a creature can attack is checked only as the declare attackers step begins. Whether a creature can block an attacking creature is checked only as the declare blockers step begins.

Calming Licit

{2}{W}

Creature ? Licit

2/2

{W}, {T}: Calming Licit loses this ability and becomes an Aura enchantment with enchant creature. Attach it to target creature. You may pay {W} to end this effect.

Enchanted creature can't attack.

Dauthi Trapper

{2}{B}

Creature ? Dauthi Minion

1/1

{T}: Target creature gains shadow until end of turn. (It can block or be blocked by only creatures with shadow.)

* Once the active player has declared which creatures are attacking, causing one of those creatures to be unable to attack won't have any effect that combat. The creature will continue to attack. This kind of ability can prevent an attack, but it can't undo an attack.

* Once the active player has declared which creatures are attacking, forcing one of that player's other creatures to attack that turn if able won't have any effect that combat.

* Once the defending player has declared which creatures are blocking, causing one of those creatures to be unable to block won't have any effect that combat. The declared blocks won't change. The same is true if, after becoming blocked, an attacking creature becomes unblockable, gains fear, gains shadow, or so on. These kinds of abilities can prevent blocks if they're played before the declare blockers step, but they can't undo blocks that have already been declared.

CARD-SPECIFIC NOTES

Awakening

{2}{G}{G}

Enchantment

At the beginning of each upkeep, untap all creatures and lands.

* The untapping caused by Awakening's ability is in addition to the normal untapping that happens during the untap step. That means a creature or land could untap during the untap step, become tapped during the upkeep step before this ability resolves, and then untap again.

* All creatures and lands untap when Awakening's ability resolves whether their controller wants them to or not. Effects that would cause a creature or land to stay tapped during its controller's untap step don't apply.

* In a Two-Headed Giant game, Awakening's ability triggers only once per upkeep, not once for each player.

Bandage

{W}

Instant

Prevent the next 1 damage that would be dealt to target creature or player this turn.

Draw a card.

* You draw a card when Bandage resolves, not when the damage is actually prevented.

Burgeoning

{G}

Enchantment

Whenever an opponent plays a land, you may put a land card from your hand into play.

* Burgeoning's ability triggers only when an opponent performs the game action of playing a land. It won't trigger when an opponent puts a land into play as part of a spell or ability's effect.

Cannibalize

{1}{B}

Sorcery

Choose two target creatures controlled by the same player. Remove one of those creatures from the game and put two +1/+1 counters on the other.

* You choose the two target creatures as you play Cannibalize. You don't choose which creature gets the counters and which one is removed from the game until Cannibalize resolves.

* If only one of the chosen creatures is still a legal target as Cannibalize resolves, it must be removed from the game.

Contemplation

{1}{W}{W}

Enchantment

Whenever you play a spell, you gain 1 life.

* Contemplation's ability resolves after you play the spell, but before the spell resolves. That means if the spell deals damage to you as it resolves (like Earthquake would), you'll have already gained 1 life by that point?but if the spell asks you to pay life as an additional cost (like Slaughter does), you will not have gained 1 life by then.

* Playing Contemplation won't trigger its own ability because it's not yet in play by that point.

Contempt

{1}{U}

Enchantment ? Aura

Enchant creature

Whenever enchanted creature attacks, return it and Contempt to their owners' hands at end of combat.

* Contempt is returned to its owner's hand only if it's still in play by the time the delayed triggered ability resolves. The same is true for the creature. If either one of them isn't in play by that point, the other is still returned.

* The creature that's returned to its owner's hand is the one that Contempt was enchanting at the time it attacked, not the one that Contempt is enchanting as the delayed triggered ability resolves (if it's different).

Conviction

{1}{W}

Enchantment ? Aura

Enchant creature

Enchanted creature gets +1/+3.

{W}: Return Conviction to its owner's hand.

* Only the Aura's controller, not the enchanted creature's controller, can play the last ability.

* If the creature the Aura is attached to leaves play, the Aura will be put into its owner's graveyard as a state-based effect. This happens before you could play the last ability to return it to your hand. The same is true if the creature the Aura is attached to stops being a creature, gains protection from the Aura's color, or otherwise becomes illegal for the Aura to enchant. (This means that if you want to return the Aura to its owner's hand, you'll need to do so before the creature becomes illegal to enchant. You'll usually get a chance to do this in response to the spell, ability, or combat damage that would make that creature illegal.)

Dream Halls

{3}{U}{U}

Enchantment

Rather than pay the mana cost for a spell, its controller may discard a card that shares a color with that spell.

* All Dream Halls does is let you pay an alternative cost for a spell rather than pay its mana cost. You must follow the normal timing rules for that spell. It can be countered.

* If you play a card by using this alternative cost, you can't pay any other alternative costs, such as evoke or the alternative cost provided by the morph ability. However, you can pay optional additional costs, such as conspire, and you must still pay mandatory additional costs, such as the one on Goldmeadow Stalwart.

* If you play a card with X in its cost this way, X must be 0.

* The card you discard must share a color with the spell you're playing, but it doesn't have to have the exact same colors. For example, you may discard a card that's blue and red to play a spell that's red and green.

* You can't play colorless spells this way. No card shares a color with a colorless spell, so the alternative cost is impossible to pay.

Dream Prowler

{2}{U}{U}

Creature ? Illusion

1/5

Dream Prowler is unblockable as long as it's attacking alone.

* Dream Prowler is "attacking alone" as long as it's attacking and no other creatures are attacking. This is continually checked. For example, if Dream Prowler and another creature attack, then that other creature is returned to its owner's hand, Dream Prowler is now attacking alone.

* Whether Dream Prowler is unblockable is relevant only as the declare blockers step begins.

Elven Rite

{1}{G}

Sorcery

Distribute two +1/+1 counters among one or two target creatures.

* As you play Elven Rite, the number of targets you choose will determine what it does. You can either put two +1/+1 counters on a single target creature, or one +1/+1 counter on each of two target creatures.

* If Elven Rite is played targeting two creatures but only one legal target remains when it resolves, both +1/+1 counters will be put on the remaining target creature.

Endangered Armodon

{2}{G}{G}

Creature ? Elephant

4/5

When you control a creature with toughness 2 or less, sacrifice Endangered Armodon.

* This ability is a state trigger. Once it triggers, it won't trigger again as long as the ability is on the stack. If the ability is countered and the trigger condition is still true, it will immediately trigger again.

* When the ability resolves, Endangered Armodon will be sacrificed whether or not you still control a creature with toughness 2 or less at that time.

Fling

{1}{R}

Instant

As an additional cost to play Fling, sacrifice a creature.

Fling deals damage equal to the sacrificed creature's power to target creature or player.

* The damage dealt by Fling is equal to the power of the sacrificed creature as it last existed in play.

* If a copy of Fling is played (due to Isochron Scepter, perhaps), the additional cost will have to be paid. However, if a copy of Fling is created on the stack (due to Twincast, perhaps), no costs are paid for it. The damage dealt by that copy of Fling is equal to the power of the creature sacrificed to pay the original spell's additional cost.

Heartstone

{3}

Artifact

Activated abilities of creatures cost {1} less to play. This effect can't reduce the amount of mana an ability costs to play to less than 1 mana.

* Heartstone won't affect a cost that isn't the cost to play a creature's activated ability. For example, it won't affect Flameblast Dragon's {X}{R} cost, since that's a cost paid when a triggered ability resolves, and it won't affect a kicker cost, since that's an additional cost to play a spell. Activated ability costs appear before a colon in a card's rules text, or, in the case of some keywords, before a colon in reminder text.

* Heartstone reduces the cost to play activated abilities of creatures that are in play. It won't affect the abilities of creature sources that are not in play, such as cycling or Carrionette's ability.

* Heartstone won't affect the part of an activation cost represented by colored mana symbols or snow mana symbols. It also won't affect nonmana parts of an activation cost, if there are any.

* Heartstone can reduce the amount you pay for a creature's activated ability cost that includes {X}. For example, Magus of the Candelabra has an activated ability cost of {X}, {T}. If Heartstone is in play and you play the ability with an X of 4, you'll have to pay only 3 mana. This is true even if the ability states that {X} must be paid with a certain color of mana, as Crimson Hellkite does.

* If an activated ability of a creature costs no generic mana to play (for example, if it costs {R}{R}, or if it costs {0}), Heartstone simply won't affect it. It won't increase that cost.

* Heartstone takes the total cost to play a creature's activated ability into account, not just the cost printed on it. For example, Furnace Spirit has an activated ability that costs {R}, and Suppression Field says "Activated abilities cost {2} more to play unless they're mana abilities." Since playing Furnace Spirit's activated ability would now cost {2}{R}, Heartstone would reduce that cost to {1}{R}.

Heat of Battle

{1}{R}

Enchantment

Whenever a creature blocks, Heat of Battle deals 1 damage to that creature's controller.

* Heat of Battle's ability triggers whenever a creature is declared as a blocker. For example, if three creatures block, the ability will trigger three times. It doesn't matter how many attacking creatures each of those creatures blocks (if they're capable of blocking more than one).

* Heat of Battle's ability won't trigger if a creature is put into play blocking.

Hermit Druid

{1}{G}

Creature ? Human Druid

1/1

{G}, {T}: Reveal cards from the top of your library until you reveal a basic land card. Put that card into your hand and all other cards revealed this way into your graveyard.

* Since all the other revealed cards are being put into your graveyard at the same time, you may put them in the graveyard in any order you want.

* If there are no basic land cards in your library, you put your entire library into your graveyard in any order you want.

Hesitation

{1}{U}

Enchantment

When a spell is played, sacrifice Hesitation. If you do, counter that spell.

* Hesitation's ability is mandatory. You must sacrifice it if it's still in play under your control when its ability resolves. If you are able to sacrifice it, then you must counter the spell.

* If you can't sacrifice Hesitation when the ability resolves, then the spell isn't countered. For example, say a spell is played, Hesitation's ability triggers, then another spell is played, and Hesitation's ability triggers again. When the second ability resolves, Hesitation is sacrificed and the second spell is countered. When the first ability resolves, Hesitation can't be sacrificed, so the first spell is not countered.

Horn of Greed

{3}

Artifact

Whenever a player plays a land, that player draws a card.

* Horn of Greed's ability triggers only when a player performs the game action of playing a land. It won't trigger when a player puts a land into play as part of a spell or ability's effect.

Hornet Cannon

{4}

Artifact

{3}, {T}: Put a 1/1 Insect artifact creature token with flying and haste named Hornet into play. Destroy that creature at end of turn.

* The token will be destroyed at the end of the turn even if Hornet Cannon has left play by then.

* If the ability is played after the current turn's end of turn step has begun, the token won't be destroyed until the next turn's end of turn step.

* If the ability tries to destroy the token but it's regenerated, that token will remain in play indefinitely. The ability won't try to destroy it again at the end of the turn after that.

Intruder Alarm

{2}{U}

Enchantment

Creatures don't untap during their controllers' untap steps.

Whenever a creature comes into play, untap all creatures.

* If multiple creatures come into play at once, Intruder Alarm's second ability triggers once for each of them. All creatures will untap each time one of those abilities resolves.

Invasion Plans

{2}{R}

Enchantment

All creatures block each turn if able.

The attacking player chooses how each creature blocks each turn.

* The attacking player makes all blocking assignments. The player's choices must be legal within the normal rules for blocking, keeping in mind the requirement that each creature must block if able.

* Tapped creatures, creatures that can't block as the result of an effect, and creatures with unpaid costs to block (such as those from War Cadence) are exempt from effects that would require them to block.

* Although creatures with unpaid costs to block can't be forced to block, they may still do so while Invasion Plans is in play. For this to happen, the attacking player declares such a creature as a blocker, and the defending player chooses to pay the cost. If the defending player doesn't willingly cooperate, the attacking player can't make that creature block.

* If there are multiple combat phases in a turn, a creature that blocked in one doesn't have to block in the others, but may do so if the attacking player wishes.

* In a Two-Headed Giant game, the attacking team chooses how each creature blocks each turn.

Jinxed Ring

{2}

Artifact

Whenever a nontoken permanent is put into your graveyard from play, Jinxed Ring deals 1 damage to you.

Sacrifice a creature: Target opponent gains control of Jinxed Ring. (This effect doesn't end at end of turn.)

* If a nontoken permanent is put into your graveyard from play, Jinxed Ring's first ability will trigger. It doesn't matter who controlled that permanent as it last existed in play.

* If you sacrifice a nontoken creature to play Jinxed Ring's second ability, its first ability will trigger in response. Jinxed Ring will deal 1 damage to you before the targeted opponent gains control of it.

* The second ability's effect has no duration. Jinxed Ring will remain under the targeted opponent's control until the game ends, it leaves play, or some other effect (such as the next time its second ability resolves) changes its controller.

Lowland Basilisk

{2}{G}

Creature ? Basilisk

1/3

Whenever Lowland Basilisk deals damage to a creature, destroy that creature at end of combat.

* Lowland Basilisk's ability triggers on any damage that it deals to a creature, not just combat damage. If it manages to deal damage to a creature outside of the combat phase, or after the current combat phase's end of combat step has begun, the damaged creature won't be destroyed until the next end of combat step (even if it's during the following turn).

* If the ability tries to destroy the damaged creature but it's regenerated, that creature will remain in play indefinitely. The ability won't try to destroy it again at the end of the combat step after that.

Mask of the Mimic

{U}

Instant

As an additional cost to play Mask of the Mimic, sacrifice a creature.

Search your library for a card with the same name as target nontoken creature and put that card into play. Then shuffle your library.

* To pay Mask of the Mimic's additional cost, you may sacrifice the creature that you targeted. However, if you do, Mask of the Mimic will be countered for having an illegal target, so you won't get to search your library for another card.

* If you target a creature whose name has been changed by an effect (for example, a Clone that's copying another creature), you'll search for a card with the new name, not one with the original name.

* If you choose a creature with no name, such as a face-down creature, no card in your library can be found with that name.

* If you find a card that isn't a permanent card while searching (for example, you targeted a Clone that's copying an Illusion token and find the split card Illusion/Reality), that card remains in your library.

Mob Justice

{1}{R}

Sorcery

Mob Justice deals damage to target player equal to the number of creatures you control.

* The amount of damage is determined when the spell resolves.

Mogg Bombers

{3}{R}

Creature ? Goblin

3/4

When another creature comes into play, sacrifice Mogg Bombers. If you do, it deals 3 damage to target player.

* Mogg Bombers's ability is mandatory. You must sacrifice it if it's still in play under your control when its ability resolves.

* If you can't sacrifice Mogg Bombers when the ability resolves, then it deals no damage. For example, say multiple creatures come into play at the same time. Mogg Bombers's ability will trigger that many times. When the first of these triggers resolves, you sacrifice Mogg Bombers and it deals 3 damage to the targeted player. When the other triggers resolve, Mogg Bombers won't be in play, so it can't be sacrificed and no further damage will be dealt.

* Mogg Bombers's ability will trigger if another creature comes into play at the same time as Mogg Bombers does.

Mogg Flunkies

{1}{R}

Creature ? Goblin

3/3

Mogg Flunkies can't attack or block alone.

* Mogg Flunkies can't be declared as an attacker unless at least one other creature is also declared as an attacker. Mogg Flunkies can't be declared as a blocker unless at least one other creature is also declared as a blocker. It's okay if that other creature is also a Mogg Flunkies.

* Once Mogg Flunkies has been legally declared as an attacker, it will continue to attack even if all other attacking creatures are removed from combat and Mogg Flunkies winds up attacking alone. The same is true regarding blocking.

Mogg Infestation

{3}{R}{R}

Sorcery

Destroy all creatures target player controls. For each creature put into a graveyard this way, put two 1/1 red Goblin creature tokens into play under that player's control.

* The targeted player gets the Goblin tokens for each creature put into a graveyard this way, regardless of whose graveyard those creatures are actually put into.

* If a creature is not put into a graveyard this way, perhaps because it regenerates, is indestructible, or a replacement effect causes it to go somewhere else instead of the graveyard, then no Goblin tokens are put into play for it.

* A token creature is put into its owner's graveyard when it's destroyed, so if Mogg Infestation causes a token creature to be destroyed, its owner will get two Goblin tokens for it.

Mogg Maniac

{1}{R}

Creature ? Goblin

1/1

Whenever Mogg Maniac is dealt damage, it deals that much damage to target opponent.

* Even if the amount of damage dealt to Mogg Maniac is enough to destroy it, Mogg Maniac's ability will trigger and it will deal the full amount of damage to the target.

Mortuary

{3}{B}

Enchantment

Whenever a creature is put into your graveyard from play, put that card on top of your library.

* This ability is mandatory.

* It doesn't matter who controlled the creature as it last existed in play. If it's put into your graveyard from play, Mortuary's ability will trigger.

* If multiple creatures are put into your graveyard from play at the same time, Mortuary's ability will trigger once for each of them. You put those abilities on the stack in any order you want, so, in essence, you put those creature cards on top of your library in any order you want.

* If, after the ability triggers, the creature card is removed from your graveyard in response, it won't be put on top of your library.

* If a token creature is put into your graveyard from play, Mortuary's ability will trigger. However, that token will cease to exist before the ability resolves.

Mox Diamond

{0}

Artifact

If Mox Diamond would come into play, you may discard a land card instead. If you do, put Mox Diamond into play. If you don't, put it into its owner's graveyard.

{T}: Add one mana of any color to your mana pool.

* If you don't discard a land card, Mox Diamond never comes into play -- it goes directly to your graveyard. This is true no matter how Mox Diamond would come into play.

Portcullis

{4}

Artifact

Whenever a creature comes into play, if there are two or more other creatures in play, remove that creature from the game.

When Portcullis leaves play, return to play under their owners' control all creatures removed from the game with Portcullis.

* Portcullis's first ability has an "intervening 'if' clause." That means (1) the ability won't trigger at all unless two or more other creatures are in play, and (2) the ability will do nothing unless two or more other creatures are in play at the time it resolves.

* If multiple creatures come into play at the same time, those creatures are counted when determining if there are two or more other creatures in play. If there are, Portcullis's first ability triggers once for each creature that came into play. Portcullis's controller puts those abilities on the stack in any order he or she wants. The creatures are removed from the game one at a time, as each ability resolves. This means that some of those creatures might not be removed from the game, since by the time the appropriate ability resolves, there might not be two other creatures in play anymore.

* A creature actually comes into play before Portcullis removes it from the game. If that creature has a "comes into play" ability, it will trigger. That ability and Portcullis's first ability trigger at the same time, so first the player whose turn it is puts his or her triggers on the stack in any order that player wants, then each other player in turn order does the same. The last trigger put on the stack will be the first one to resolve. The creature's "comes into play" ability will resolve, though the creature might not be in play by the time that happens.

* If more than one Portcullis is in play when a creature comes into play, the first ability of each Portcullis will trigger. Since all these abilities trigger at the same time, first the player whose turn it is puts his or her triggers on the stack in any order that player wants, then each other player in turn order does the same. The last trigger put on the stack will be the first

one to resolve. Only the first Portcullis ability to resolve will remove the creature from the game. The rest will resolve and do nothing.

* If Portcullis leaves play after its first ability triggers but before it resolves, its second ability will trigger and return to play all creatures that Portcullis has already removed from the game. Then its first ability will resolve and remove from the game the creature that caused it to trigger. That creature won't come back.

* If a creature phases in, Portcullis's first ability will not trigger.

Provoke

{1}{G}

Instant

Untap target creature you don't control. That creature blocks this turn if able.

Draw a card.

* Provoke can target any creature you don't control. That creature doesn't have to be tapped.

* Tapped creatures, creatures that can't block as the result of an effect, and creatures with unpaid costs to block (such as those from War Cadence) are exempt from effects that would require them to block.

Pursuit of Knowledge

{3}{W}

Enchantment

If you would draw a card, you may put a study counter on Pursuit of Knowledge instead.

Remove three study counters from Pursuit of Knowledge, Sacrifice Pursuit of Knowledge: Draw seven cards.

* If an effect such as Sift would cause you to draw multiple cards, you choose for each individual draw whether to replace it by Pursuit of Knowledge's effect. Process the draws one at a time.

* If two or more replacement effects would apply to a card-drawing event, the player who's drawing the card chooses what order to apply them. It's possible that after applying one of them, the others will no longer be applicable because the player would no longer draw a card. For example, if you have more than one Pursuit of Knowledge in play and you would draw a card, each Pursuit of Knowledge's replacement effect could apply. Once you use one and put a study counter on a Pursuit of Knowledge instead of drawing a card, the rest are no longer applicable.

* Activating Pursuit of Knowledge's second ability will cause you to draw seven cards, regardless of how many study counters are on it (as long as there are at least three, of course). Since you sacrifice Pursuit of Knowledge as part of the ability's cost, there's no way to play the ability more than once.

Rabid Rats

{1}{B}

Creature ? Rat

1/1

{T}: Target blocking creature gets -1/-1 until end of turn.

* A "blocking creature" is one that has been declared as a blocker this combat, or one that was put into play blocking this combat. Unless that creature leaves combat itself, it continues to be a blocking creature through the end of combat step, even if the creature or creatures that it was blocking are no longer in play or have otherwise left combat by then.

Rebound

{1}{U}

Instant

Change the target of target spell that targets only a player. The new target must be a player.

* When Rebound resolves, you must change the target if able. If you can't choose a legal target player for the spell at this time, its target doesn't change (even if that target also happens to be illegal at this time).

* Although you're changing the target of the spell, the spell's controller remains unchanged. For example, if that spell says "target opponent," the new target must be an opponent of the spell's controller, not necessarily an opponent of you.

* If a spell targets multiple things, you can't target it with Rebound, even if all but one of those targets has become illegal.

* If a spell has multiple targets, but it's targeting the same player with all of them, you can target that spell with Rebound. In that case, you change all of those targets to the same new target player, as long as it meets each of the spell's targeting conditions.

Reins of Power

{2}{U}{U}

Instant

Untap all creatures you control and all creatures target opponent controls. You and that opponent each gain control of all creatures the other controls until end of turn. Those creatures gain haste until end of turn.

* You change control of each creature controlled by you and the targeted opponent, not just the ones untapped by Reins of Power.

* It's okay if either player controls no creatures. The other player's creatures will still change control as instructed.

Rolling Stones

{1}{W}

Enchantment

Wall creatures can attack as though they didn't have defender.

* Rolling Stones doesn't affect creatures with defender that aren't Walls.

Sacred Ground

{1}{W}

Enchantment

Whenever a spell or ability an opponent controls causes a land to be put into your graveyard from play, return that card to play.

* This ability is mandatory.

* It doesn't matter who controlled the land as it last existed in play. If it's put into your graveyard from play as the direct result of a spell or ability an opponent controls, Sacred Ground's ability will trigger.

* If multiple lands are put into your graveyard from play at the same time as the direct result of a spell or ability an opponent controls, Sacred Ground's ability will trigger once for each of them. You put those abilities on the stack in any order you want, so, in essence, you return those land cards to play in any order you want.

* If, after the ability triggers, the land card is removed from your graveyard in response, it won't be returned to play.

* Sacred Ground's ability will not trigger if a state-based effect causes a land to be put into your graveyard from play, even if a spell or ability an opponent controlled led to that state-based effect being relevant. For example, if you control a land that's also a creature, and a spell or ability an opponent controls deals lethal damage to it or reduces its toughness to 0, that permanent is put into the graveyard as a state-based effect. Sacred Ground won't return it to play.

Scapegoat

{W}

Instant

As an additional cost to play Scapegoat, sacrifice a creature.

Return any number of target creatures you control to their owner's hand.

* To pay Scapegoat's additional cost, you may sacrifice one of the creatures that you targeted. However, if you do, that creature won't be returned to your hand when Scapegoat resolves because it will no longer be in play. If that creature was Scapegoat's only target, Scapegoat will be countered for having no legal targets.

Shaman en-Kor

{1}{W}

Creature ? Kor Shaman Cleric

1/2

{0}: The next 1 damage that would be dealt to Shaman en-Kor this turn is dealt to target creature you control instead.

{1}{W}: The next time a source of your choice would deal damage to target creature this turn, that damage is dealt to Shaman en-Kor instead.

* You may use Shaman en-Kor's two abilities in tandem, first redirecting damage that would be dealt to the targeted creature to Shaman en-Kor, then splitting that damage up and redirecting it among any number of target creatures you control.

Silver Wyvern

{3}{U}{U}

Creature ? Drake

4/3

Flying

{U}: Change the target of target spell or ability that targets only Silver Wyvern. The new target must be a creature.

* When Silver Wyvern's second ability resolves, you must change the target if able. If you can't choose a legal target creature for the spell or ability at this time, its target doesn't change (even if that target also happens to be illegal at this time).

* Although you're changing the target of the spell or ability, its controller remains unchanged. For example, if that spell or ability says "target creature an opponent controls," the new target creature must be controlled by an opponent of the spell's controller, not necessarily controlled by an opponent of you.

* If a spell or ability targets multiple things, you can't target it with Silver Wyvern's second ability, even if all but one of those targets has become illegal.

* If a spell or ability has multiple targets, but it's targeting Silver Wyvern with all of them (such as Seeds of Strength targeting Silver Wyvern three times), you can target that spell or ability with Silver Wyvern's second ability. In that case, you change all of those targets to the same new target creature, as long as it meets each of the spell's targeting conditions.

Skeleton Scavengers

{2}{B}

Creature ? Skeleton

0/0

Skeleton Scavengers comes into play with a +1/+1 counter on it.

Pay {1} for each +1/+1 counter on Skeleton Scavengers: Regenerate Skeleton Scavengers. When it regenerates this way, put a +1/+1 counter on it.

* Playing Skeleton Scavengers's ability does not put a +1/+1 counter on it right away. Rather, it creates a regeneration shield. If Skeleton Scavengers would be destroyed that turn, instead it uses that shield and regenerates. When that happens, its delayed triggered ability triggers. Only when it resolves is a +1/+1 counter put on Skeleton Scavengers.

* Each instance of the delayed triggered ability is correlated to a specific regeneration shield, and no others. Playing the ability multiple times won't cause multiple +1/+1 counters to be put on Skeleton Scavengers the next time it regenerates.

* The cost to play Skeleton Scavenger's activated ability is determined at the time that ability is played. Once you've paid the cost, a regeneration shield is created. That shield will work even if Skeleton Scavengers gets more +1/+1 counters put on it before it's used.

Sliver Queen

{W}{U}{B}{R}{G}

Legendary Creature ? Sliver

7/7

{2}: Put a 1/1 colorless Sliver creature token into play.

* Although the Sliver creature tokens are colorless, they are not artifacts.

* Although neither Sliver Queen nor the tokens it creates have abilities that affect all other Slivers, they are still Slivers. Abilities of other Slivers that affect all Slivers will affect them.

Smite

{W}

Instant

Destroy target blocked creature.

* A "blocked creature" is an attacking creature that has been blocked by a creature this combat, or has become blocked as the result of a spell or ability this combat. Unless the attacking creature leaves combat itself, it continues to be a blocked creature through the end of combat step, even if the creature or creatures that blocked it are no longer in play or have otherwise left combat by then.

Spike Soldier

{2}{G}{G}

Creature ? Spike Soldier

0/0

Spike Soldier comes into play with three +1/+1 counters on it.

{2}, Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spike Soldier: Put a +1/+1 counter on target creature.

Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spike Soldier: Spike Soldier gets +2/+2 until end of turn.

* The +1/+1 counter is removed as you play Spike Soldier's last ability, but Spike Soldier doesn't get +2/+2 until that ability resolves. If you remove the last counter this way, Spike Soldier will be put into the graveyard for having 0 toughness before the ability resolves.

Spitting Hydra

{3}{R}{R}

Creature ? Hydra

0/0

Spitting Hydra comes into play with four +1/+1 counters on it.

{1}{R}, Remove a +1/+1 counter from Spitting Hydra: Spitting Hydra deals 1 damage to target creature.

* If Spitting Hydra has been dealt damage, not all of its counters can be removed to play its second ability that turn. For example, if Spitting Hydra still has four +1/+1 counters on it but has been dealt 3 damage, playing its second ability will cause it to be a 3/3 creature with 3 damage on it, so it will be destroyed as a state-based effect. The ability you played will resolve, but you won't get a chance to remove any other counters.

Temper

{X}{1}{W}

Instant

Prevent the next X damage that would be dealt to target creature this turn. For each 1 damage prevented this way, put a +1/+1 counter on that creature.

* The +1/+1 counters are put onto the creature at the time the damage is prevented. For example, if a 1/1 creature would be dealt 6 damage and Temper is played with an X of 3, then 3 damage is prevented, three +1/+1 counters are put on the creature, and 3 damage is dealt to it all at the same time. The creature is now a 4/4 creature with 3 damage on it, so it won't be destroyed.

* The number of +1/+1 counters put on the creature is equal to the amount of damage prevented by Temper, not equal to the value of X. If X exceeds the amount of damage that was prevented, the remaining damage prevention shield will remain on that creature in case more damage would be dealt to it later that turn.

Tempting Lcid

{2}{G}

Creature ? Lcid

2/2

{G}, {T}: Tempting Lcid loses this ability and becomes an Aura enchantment with enchant creature. Attach it to target creature. You may pay {G} to end this effect.

All creatures able to block enchanted creature do so.

* Tapped creatures, creatures that can't block as the result of an effect, and creatures with unpaid costs to block (such as those from War Cadence) are exempt from effects that would require them to block.

Thalakos Deceiver

{3}{U}

Creature ? Thalakos Wizard

1/1

Shadow (This creature can block or be blocked by only creatures with shadow.)

Whenever Thalagos Deceiver attacks and isn't blocked, you may sacrifice it. If you do, gain control of target creature. (This effect doesn't end at end of turn.)

* Thalagos Deceiver's second ability resolves during the declare blockers step. If you gain control of an attacking or blocking creature you don't already control, that creature is removed from combat. It will neither deal nor be dealt combat damage.

* If there are no other creatures in play when Thalagos Deceiver's second ability triggers, it will have to target Thalagos Deceiver itself. Of course, you can choose not to use the ability when it resolves.

* The second ability's effect has no duration. The targeted creature will remain under your control until the game ends, it leaves play, or some other effect changes its controller.

Tidal Warrior

{U}

Creature ? Merfolk Warrior

1/1

{T}: Target land becomes an Island until end of turn.

* The targeted land loses its existing land types and any abilities printed on it. It now has the ability to tap to add {U} to its controller's mana pool. This ability doesn't change the targeted land's name or whether it's legendary or basic.

Tortured Existence

{B}

Enchantment

{B}, Discard a creature card: Return target creature card from your graveyard to your hand.

* You must choose a target for Tortured Existence's ability before you pay its cost. For that reason, you can't return to your hand the same creature card that you discard to pay the cost.

Verdant Touch

{1}{G}

Sorcery

Buyback {3} (You may pay an additional {3} as you play this spell. If you do, put this card into your hand as it resolves.)

Target land becomes a 2/2 creature that's still a land. (This effect doesn't end at end of turn.)

* Verdant Touch's effect has no duration. The affected land will remain both a creature and a land until the game ends, it leaves play, or some other effect changes its types.

* A noncreature permanent that turns into a creature is subject to the "summoning sickness" rule: It can attack, and its {T} abilities can be played, only if its controller has continuously controlled that permanent since the beginning of his or her most recent turn.

Volrath's Laboratory

{5}

Artifact

As Volrath's Laboratory comes into play, choose a color and a creature type. {5}, {T}: Put a 2/2 creature token of the chosen color and type into play .

* The token has no abilities, regardless of what its creature type is. For example, choosing creature type Wall doesn't mean the token has defender, and choosing creature type Angel doesn't mean it has flying.

Volrath's Shapeshifter

{1}{U}{U}

Creature ? Shapeshifter

0/1

As long as the top card of your graveyard is a creature card, Volrath's Shapeshifter has the full text of that card and has the text "{2}: Discard a card." (Volrath's Shapeshifter has that card's name, mana cost, color, types, abilities, power, and toughness.)

{2}: Discard a card.

* As printed, Volrath's Shapeshifter had a copy ability. However, when the rules regarding the interaction of continuous effects changed, this ability no longer worked. Since this ability checked its controller's graveyard, Volrath's Shapeshifter needed to apply control-change effects (layer 2) before copy effects (layer 1), which is the opposite of how the game works. So this ability became a text-changing effect (layer 3), which is indeed applied after control-change effects.

* If a creature card has two abilities printed on it such that one of them causes actions to be taken or objects to be affected and the other one directly refers to those actions or objects, those two abilities are linked: the second refers only to actions that were taken or objects that were affected by the first, and not by any other ability. If Volrath's Shapeshifter acquires the text of those abilities, they're still linked. For example, if Volrath's Shapeshifter becomes a copy of Nyxathid, the second Nyxathid ability (which refers to the "chosen player") refers only to a player chosen by the first Nyxathid ability (which instructs you to "choose an opponent"). It won't refer to a player chosen by any other ability that Volrath's Shapeshifter may have had -- even by an ability of a previous Nyxathid. If an ability refers to an undefined choice, that part of the ability has no effect.

* Despite the fact that it's not a copy effect, it pretty much works as you'd expect, and as it always has. Volrath's Shapeshifter has the "full text" of the top card of your graveyard if it's a creature card. That includes all copiable characteristics of that card: name, mana cost, color, types, expansion symbol, abilities, power, and toughness. Volrath's Shapeshifter's own characteristics are overwritten. This is true even if the card it's taking its characteristics

from lacks any characteristics (for example, if it's colorless), or any of its characteristics can't be determined (for example, it's got a "*" in its power or toughness and the ability that defines that * requires information about a choice that hasn't been made).

* While the top card of your library is a creature, Volrath's Shapeshifter also has its "{2}: Discard a card" ability, though it does not visibly have its static ability. Despite that fact, the ability continues to work as normal since it's there under the surface. If the top card of your library changes, Volrath's Shapeshifter changes accordingly.

* If another permanent becomes a copy of Volrath's Shapeshifter, it will copy Volrath's Shapeshifter's printed characteristics, not the characteristics of whatever Volrath's Shapeshifter happens to be mimicking. That means it will have Volrath's Shapeshifter's static ability, so its characteristics will change to those of the top card of its controller's graveyard, if that card is a creature. If Volrath's Shapeshifter and the permanent that's copying it are both controlled by the same player, they'll each wind up as the same creature. If they're controlled by different players, each one will look at its own controller's graveyard.

* If the top card of your graveyard is a creature card at the time Volrath's Shapeshifter comes into play, it comes into play with the appropriate characteristics of that card. Any "comes into play" abilities of that card will trigger. In addition, any "as [this creature] comes into play" abilities and "this creature comes into play with [certain] counters on it" abilities will work. For example, if the top card of your graveyard is Spike Colony, Volrath's Shapeshifter will come into play with four +1/+1 counters on it.

* If Dryad Arbor is the top card of your graveyard when Volrath's Shapeshifter comes into play, it doesn't count against your play-one-land-a-turn limit. This is because you didn't play Volrath's Shapeshifter as a land.

* If the top card of your graveyard is not a creature card, Volrath's Shapeshifter has its own characteristics.

* The game can track cards that are continually in your graveyard. For example, say you have Volrath's Shapeshifter in play, the top card of your graveyard is Rootwalla, and you play the Shapeshifter's Rootwalla ability. If a new card is put on top of your graveyard, the Shapeshifter will lose the Rootwalla ability. If that new top card leaves your graveyard and that same Rootwalla becomes the top card of your library again that turn, the Shapeshifter will have the Rootwalla ability again. However, since it's the same Rootwalla, it's the same ability. Since you can play that ability only once each turn, you can't play that ability again. If, on the other hand, a new Rootwalla is put on top of your graveyard, Volrath's Shapeshifter gets a new ability that can be played that turn. If a card leaves your graveyard and then returns to your graveyard later, it's considered a new object with no relation to its previous existence.

Wall of Essence

{1}{W}

Creature ? Wall

0/4

Defender (This creature can't attack.)

Whenever Wall of Essence is dealt combat damage, you gain that much life.

* Even if the amount of combat damage dealt to Wall of Essence is enough to destroy it, Wall of Essence's ability will trigger and you will gain the full amount of life.

Wall of Souls

{1}{B}

Creature ? Wall

0/4

Defender (This creature can't attack.)

Whenever Wall of Souls is dealt combat damage, it deals that much damage to target opponent.

* Even if the amount of combat damage dealt to Wall of Souls is enough to destroy it, Wall of Souls's ability will trigger and it will deal the full amount of damage to the target.

Wall of Tears

{1}{U}

Creature ? Wall

0/4

Defender (This creature can't attack.)

Whenever Wall of Tears blocks a creature, return that creature to its owner's hand at end of combat.

* The blocked creature is returned to its owner's hand at end of combat only if the blocked creature is still in play. It doesn't matter whether Wall of Tears is in play at that point.

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